

18 Things Every Senior Should Know

There's a huge amount of help for older adults — money, health, food, home, and more — that many seniors never claim. Below are the key starting points, all free to explore. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

One free call to the Eldercare Locator (1-800-677-1110) can connect you to most of what's below in your area. Programs are free to apply for — never pay a "benefits consultant" for what you can get directly.

1 Start With One Free Call

The single best entry point to senior help nationwide.

☐ Eldercare Locator

Free connection to local services: meals, transport, caregiver help, and more.

→ eldercare.acl.gov 1-800-677-1110

☐ BenefitsCheckUp

Free tool that finds benefits you may qualify for, from medicine to food to utilities.

→ www.benefitscheckup.org

2 Money & Health Coverage

Income support and help with health costs.

☐ Social Security & SSI

Retirement, disability, and SSI for those with low income. Check what you're owed.

→ www.ssa.gov 1-800-772-1213

☐ Medicare & Free SHIP Counseling

Free, unbiased Medicare help to cut costs. See the Medicare guide.

→ www.shiphelp.org SHIP: 1-877-839-2675

☐ Medicare Savings & Extra Help

Programs that pay premiums and drug costs for limited incomes.

→ www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/help/medicare-savings-programs

3 Food, Home & Utilities

Everyday essentials made affordable.

☐ Senior Meals & SNAP

Home-delivered/community meals and food benefits (easier rules for those 60+).

→ www.nutrition.gov/topics/food-assistance-programs/meals-seniors

☐ LIHEAP & Weatherization

Help with energy bills and free home energy upgrades. See the Utility guide.

→ www.acf.hhs.gov/ocs/programs/liheap 1-866-674-6327

4 Protect Yourself

Stay safe from fraud and know where to turn.

☐ Report Elder Fraud

Free help if you're targeted by a scam (seniors are common targets).

→ ovc.ojp.gov/program/stop-elder-fraud DOJ Elder Fraud: 1-833-372-8311

☐ Free Legal Help for Seniors

Legal aid for benefits, housing, and elder-law issues via the Eldercare Locator.

→ eldercare.acl.gov 1-800-677-1110

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Seniors are the #1 target for scams. Medicare, Social Security, and the IRS will never call to demand payment or your number — hang up and call the official line yourself. Never pay to “claim” free benefits.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Start with one call to the Eldercare Locator or a BenefitsCheckUp online — either can reveal thousands of dollars in benefits you may be missing, then point you to free local help to apply.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your local Area Agency on Aging and senior services, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll connect you.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
